

Retrospective — Phases 4 through 7

What worked well Introductory depth was the right call — phases 4–7 were scoped to avoid overwhelm and prevent process stagnation, not because of a lack of ambition. Iterative design in Phases 6 & 7 matched the user's cognitive style — trying something, reflecting, and adjusting produced a stronger result than locking decisions up front. Bite-sized prompts kept sessions moving. No single task triggered shutdown. A live URL shipped. That is the primary success metric. It is met. User correctly distinguished between personal aesthetic preference and evaluator need — a genuine PM thinking pattern.	What to improve Late-night sessions (ending 4–6am) degraded retention. Process knowledge blurred across the irregular session gaps. Pacing is a system constraint, not a willpower problem. User stories and acceptance criteria felt administrative rather than functional — they weren't visible during design decisions, so their value wasn't felt in real time. Documentation and version tracking remain a friction point. The tedium is real. Mitigation: tighter artifact templates and shorter update loops at P1. Coaching feedback still weighted toward encouragement. Calibration increases begin at P1 as planned.	Questions still open Is the current site design flexible enough to absorb future projects? Decision deferred correctly — stress-test with real P1 artifacts before changing anything. What is P1's project? Word game deprioritised — feature scope too large for a second project. Alternatives to be evaluated at P1 kickoff against one criterion: stretches capability without triggering the stall. How does PM process vocabulary and phase structure get retained? Answer: repetition through execution, not pre-study. The second pass through the phases will feel familiar.
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Confidence score — honest calibration

Baseline (start of P0)	0.5 / 10	No system. No artifacts. No deployed product.
Post-P0 (current)	1.0 / 10	Live URL shipped. 13 artifacts approved. Process completed once. Retention is low but the path is proven.
Target — post-P1	4–5 / 10	Second full pass through all 9 phases. First draft responsibility increases. Coaching friction increases. Process starts to feel owned, not borrowed.
What moves the score	—	Executing P1 completely. Retention comes from repetition, not pre-study. Flashcards won't close the gap. Another shipped project will.

Feedback calibration scale — project by project

P0 · Portfolio		Supportive scaffolding — coach generates, user approves
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P1 · Word game / TBD		Guided drafting — user drafts first, coach critiques
P2 · TBD		Critical collaboration — assumptions challenged
P3 · TBD		CPO peer review mode — respond as a CPO reviewing PM work
P4+ · TBD		Professional friction — open disagreement, user defends decisions

System improvements incorporated before P1

- **Session length — enforce the 10-minute entry point**

The 4–5 hour window belief is the stall mechanism, not a real prerequisite. P1 sessions open with one prompt and one answer. That is a complete session. The runway does not need to be long to justify starting.

- **Draft-first protocol — fully active at P1**

User drafts key artifacts in rough form before coach generates polished version. Acceptance criteria and user stories drafted by user first — so they are felt as functional tools, not administrative overhead.

- **Pushback calibration — increase at P1**

Coaching feedback shifts from encouragement-led to precision-led. Vague answers returned with a sharper follow-up question. Assumptions named and challenged. Encouragement stays — it is now paired with a specific improvement note every time.

- **P1 project selection — deliberate scoping**

Word game deprioritised. Feature scope (auth, payments, multiplayer, admin) is too large for project two. P1 project selected at kickoff against one criterion: stretches capability without triggering the stall. Alternatives welcomed.

- **Documentation rhythm — shorter loops**

Documentation aversion is real and will not disappear. Mitigation: tighter artifact templates, version updates happen at session close while context is live — not deferred to a separate session.

Artifact depth assessment — Phases 4–7

Phase	Artifact	Depth at P0	What expands at P1+
4 — Roadmap	Now / Next / Later	Introductory. Three horizons, clean sequencing, deliberate first decision.	Prioritisation frameworks (RICE, MoSCoW). Dependency mapping. Confidence scores per initiative.
5 — PRD	Product Requirements Document	Solid foundation. Eight FRs, five technical decisions, one documented tradeoff. User stories present but felt administrative.	Acceptance criteria drafted by user first. Stories tied visibly to design decisions. Edge cases documented.

6 — Design	Wireframe v4	Four iterations. Locked design system. Full zone-by-zone implementation spec. Strong signal for a first wireframing pass.	Figma introduced at P1. Component states. Interaction annotations. Handoff-ready specs.
7 — Build	Deployed site — all five zones	HTML / CSS / Vanilla JS. Five zones. Responsive CSS. Live at thepmdev.com. FR-09 WCAG 2.2 AA met.	Component-level thinking. JavaScript interactions. CI/CD discipline. Analytics live.